Managing Up

Talking to Your Leader

What does "managing up" mean to you?

How often do you report to your leader: in person, email, or an app?

Are you more task-focused or more people-focused? What about your leader?

Is your leader hands-on and attentive, or do they prefer a self-driven team?

Does your communication style match your leader's: direct or indirect?

What about working style: teamwork or solo, one task or many at once?

Is it ever a good idea to be friends with your leader? Where is the line?

What Slows You Down

Lack of clarity · time pressure · too few resources

Overlapping responsibilities · procrastination · shifting priorities

Skill gaps · personality clashes

Which of these slows you down most, and how do you get past it?

Do you ask your leader for help? What exactly do you say?

What You Need From Your Leader

Clear instructions · recognition and appreciation

Trust and autonomy · constructive feedback · space to grow

Which of these do you need most from your leader right now?

When Things Go Wrong

Micromanagement · unrealistic expectations · underdelivering

Inconsistent decisions · overpromising · results-only feedback

How do you deal with each of these situations?

If You Lead a Team

What do you not want to hear from your team?

Too much detail · problems with no solutions · a passive attitude

Excuses · office cliques · broken promises

Have you ever had a conflict with your leader? How did you handle it?

What is the single biggest thing you want from your leader?